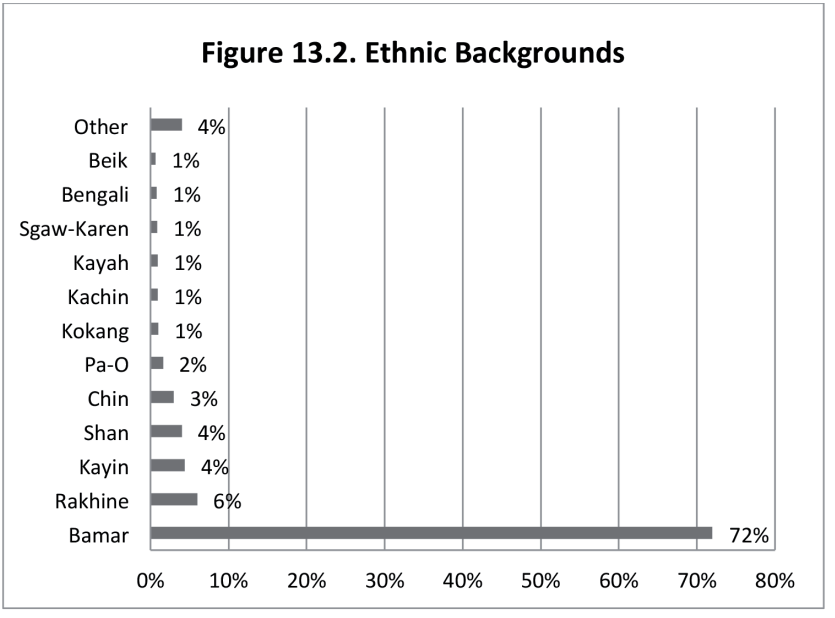
centre-periphery relations with limited decentralization of political power, systematic impoverishment and lack of control of natural resources and land. Scholars vary in their interpretations of the causes of ethnic conflict, but disproportionally the causes are identified as being associated with the actions of Myanmar's military government.

In order to examine variation in how Myanmar citizens look at ethnicity and conflict, we differentiate between the Bamar majority and ethnic minorities. A total of thirty-six different ethnic minorities were surveyed in the ABS, according to their self-identified ethnicity.[9] The breakdown of the different ethnic groups can be found below in Figure 13. 2. The largest share of ethnic minority communities surveyed was Shan, Rakhine, and Kayin. As all of the states were included in the ABS, those included resided in both the periphery as well as the centre.



The ABS confirms that ethnic minorities perceive discrimination as a matter of concern, believing that there are deep inequalities in how ethnic minorities are treated. Respondents were asked to agree or disagree with the following statement: "All citizens from different ethnic communities in Myanmar are treated equally by the government." As Figure 13.3 shows,